category includes the different types of irreducible and indestructible atoms comprising the elements (earth, water, fire and air); the atmosphere (the vehicle of sounds), time, space (which are unitary and all-pervasive); and also souls (***atman***) and the inner sense (***manas***).

Atoms are the raw material of the cosmos. They combine to form the perceptible objects that are the furniture of our world. Substances are individuated by the different arrangements of their parts.

A substance is an integrated whole (***avayavin***) product that comes into being as a novel unit, over and above the sum of its parts. The whole cannot exist without the parts in which it inheres (***samavaya***).

One argument in favour of the existence of complex objects with natures that remain stable through time is that an entity may be simultaneously seen and touched. But each sensory quality is apprehensible only through the corresponding sense organ. So what is knowable by more than one sense must be other than the sensible qualities. This object of synthetic perception must be the form of an integrated whole entity.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Halbfass 1992; Potter 1977

Drishtanta (example): in an inference (***anumana***), the general principle being appealed to needs to be supported by examples.

See ***Hetu***, ***Sapaksha*** and ***Vipaksha***

Drishya-anupalabdhi (non-cognition of the knowable): according to ***Dharmakirti***, the non-apprehension of an entity that is of a perceptible kind proves the absence of that entity. This principle is applied in arguments with those who believe that we are fundamentally souls (***atman***). The characterisations of the soul that are proposed imply